

Passengers

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Figure 1: Passengers.

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1 Abstract

Passengers is a video installation powered by generative artificial intelligence. It transforms orbital captured imagery from the International Space Station (ISS) into simulated airplane window views, accompanied by internal narratives of imagined travelers.

Conceived in an era of global fragmentation, marked by escalating geopolitical conflict and the erosion of shared consensus, the artwork responds to the increasing politicization and segmentation of the sky, once regarded as a communal visual commons. By revisiting the sky as a symbolic global public space, it questions whether this domain can still host collective modes of perception.

In contrast to contemporary fractured realities, large language models trained on global datasets paradoxically retain traces of a latent cross-cultural worldview. Through experiencing the generated airplane window visuals based on ISS orbital imagery, thirty synthetic passengers' inner voices have been created. Each voice carries diverse social resonances not derived from lived experience, but from semantic associations within the large language model's latent space. The constructed cloudscape and texts do not recall an actual past, but activate an envisioned collective sky, one that was never historically shared, yet algorithmically assembled.

By re-situating machine perception within the human ritual of sky-gazing and flight, AI assumes the role of passengers, continuously creating constructed personas that drift between planetary observation and dispersed memory.

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